

9 WAYS PLANET EARTH COULD RING IN DOOMSDAY, AND HOW YOU CAN DEAL WITH IT

The internet is rife with rumours about the apocalypse, and there are popular theories on how it would happen. We look at some real threats to Earth

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So our Doomsday clock is ticking down quickly to December 22, 2012, the day the Mayan calendar runs out, with wild speculation from conspiracy theorists that this could mean the end of the world. There's no truth to it, of course, and we aren't for a minute asking you to believe it. The Mayans actually had a large number of calendars, each for tracking different phenomenon such as crop cycles,

weather cycles, sun cycles and even one based on the position of Venus. However, their largest calendar cycle was called the "Long Count" calendar that lasts 5126 years.

Now this Long Count calendar isn't based on the base of 10 like ours, where after 10, the number goes to 11. For the Mayans, the numbers went up to 19 and then cycled. Their dates were represented as 0.0.0.0.0. So the 19th day on the calendar was represented as 0.0.0.0.19 and the 20th day would look like 0.0.0.1.0. One year looks like 0.0.1.0.0 while 20 years

look like 0.1.0.0.0. It's a little confusing, but just move one zero over every time you reach a multiple of 20 (such as 20, 40, 60 etc). Now, the Mayans also loved the number 13, using it as a base as well. Some believe that the calendar ends at 13.0.0.0.0, which is a total of 5126 years (one cycle of their Long Count calendar).

Archaeologists, historians, mathematicians, etc., estimate that the "0.0.0.0.0" period began on August 11, 3114 BC and the 13.0.0.0.0 date corresponds to December 21, 2012.